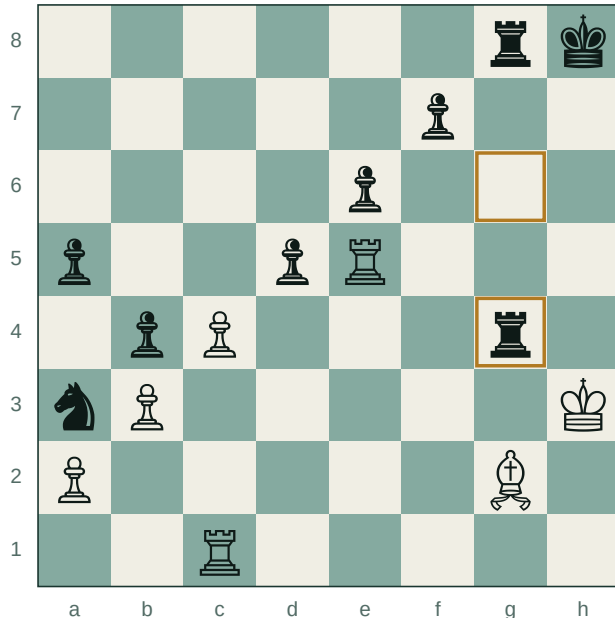


Interference tactics: White, move 37

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 36...Rxf6-g4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. Rh5+ Kg7 38. Kxg4

37.Rh5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37...Kg7**.

38.Kxg4 The king captures the rook on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.